

Orangutans



Three species of orangutan represent the great apes of tropical Asia. They depend on their wild rainforest habitats, so are now endangered as deforestation breaks up their home ranges into ever smaller patches.

Far from their kind

Shrinking habitats, separated by barriers such as rivers or roads, make it harder for adult orangutans to meet and breed. This means fewer babies are born, and populations shrink.

Borneo

Bornean orangutan

Mature male orangutans look very different from smaller females: males have fleshy cheek pads that stick out from the face, especially in the Bornean species.

Fur color

Adult Bornean orangutans have orange-brown or maroon fur.

Under threat

Sumatra and Borneo have lost more than half of their rainforests in the past century—mainly as trees are cleared for plantations that produce crops such as palm oil. If current trends continue, all orangutans could be extinct within decades.



Java

